

The Program in Action

When you run *leetspeak.py*, the output will look like this:

```
L3375P34]< (leetspeak)
By Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com

Enter your leet message:
> I am a leet hacker. Fear my mad skills. The 90s were over two decades ago.

! @m a l33t h@(<er. ph3@r my m4|) $k|ll$. +h3 90s w3r3 Over tw0 d3(ad3$ 4g0.
(Copied leetspeak to clipboard.)
```

How It Works

The dictionary in the `charMapping` variable on line 36 maps plain English characters to leetspeak characters. However, since there can be multiple possible leetspeak characters (such as '7' or '+' for the letter 't'), each value in the `charMapping` dictionary is a list of strings. When creating the new leetspeak string, the program has a 30 percent chance of simply using the character in the original English message and a 70 percent chance of using one of the leetspeak characters. This means the same English message has multiple possible leetspeak translations.

```
1. """Leetspeak, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
2. Translates English messages into l33t5p34]<.
3. View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects
4. Tags: tiny, beginner, word"""
5.
6. import random
7.
8. try:
9.     import pyperclip # pyperclip copies text to the clipboard.
10. except ImportError:
11.     pass # If pyperclip is not installed, do nothing. It's no big deal.
12.
13.
14. def main():
15.     print('L3375P34]< (leetspeak)
16. By Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
17.
18. Enter your leet message:')
19.     english = input('> ')
20.     print()
21.     leetspeak = englishToLeetspeak(english)
22.     print(leetspeak)
23.
24.     try:
25.         # Trying to use pyperclip will raise a NameError exception if
26.         # it wasn't imported:
27.         pyperclip.copy(leetspeak)
28.         print('(Copied leetspeak to clipboard.)')
```